# Sunday, 8 February 2026 (21 Shevat 5786) — The Three פרשיות, הודו, and שיר השירים

*Content-based review · reviewer read the transcripts, summary, and finished write-up · 8 November 2026*

## 1.The Shiur in One Paragraph

A Sunday-morning shiur on *tefillah*, given on the morning of the funeral of Reb Yosef Nachman ben Moshe Zelig, a founding member of the shul, and opening with a short *hesped*-in-passing (the Rebbetzin had asked that only family eulogize). It closes the long road through weekday *Shacharis* with the three small *parshiyos* printed at the end of the siddur: *Parshas HaYirah* (Rabbeinu Yonah's *Sefer HaYirah*; the Chacham Tzvi saying it while putting away his *tefillin*), *Parshas HaTeshuvah* (the *Seder HaYom*; praying for others and being answered first; the Maharsha on asking for *yiras shamayim*) and *Parshas HaMan* (the Tuesday of *Beshalach*; the daily custom; the *Tashbetz Katan* and the Maharam's "*v'ani areiv*"; before or after davening; *hamarbeh lo he'diph*; the Gra). It then begins the Shabbos prayers with *Hodu* before *Mincha* of *Erev Shabbos* (*Tehillim* 107 and the four who give thanks) and the tradition, from the *Maor Einayim*, that the Baal Shem Tov instituted it after his rescue at sea on the way to Eretz Yisrael. The long second half is *Shir HaShirim* on *Erev Shabbos*: the *tumah* of the holy writings (*Shabbos* 14a), R' Akiva in *Yadayim* ("the Holy of Holies"), the Alshich (no *pshat*, all *sod*), the moments between *mikveh* and *Shabbos*, R' Eliezer Rokeach and the Amsterdam medal (the Yaavetz's responsum), and the Rokeach's two calculations of 117: 144 − 27 hours of *Gehinnom*, and 3 × 39 lashes of Shlomo HaMelech. It ends with the acknowledgment of a guest, Rabbi Mendy Koenig, and the walk to the

funeral.

## 2.Overall Fidelity

The finished write-up follows the order of the shiur and keeps nearly all of its content, including the anecdotes. Three sources were read: the bilingual Plaud transcript (`AUDIO-2026-02-08-10-47-59.txt`; it glosses each Hebrew word and is authoritative on every point below), the Sofer-style transcript ("Speaker 1"; badly garbled in Hebrew, e.g. "Rabbeinu Yoyno" and "Parasha Sayyuro") and the AI summary. **No Sofer .docx exists for this date. The pattern is the same as in previous weeks: the write-up inherited most of its misstatements from the summary and the Sofer transcript.** The worst case this week is the first section on *Parshas HaYirah*, where the "*minhag* in Jerusalem" that "became a *takanah*" is a mishearing of the words *yiras shamayim* and has no basis in the recording. Ten other points are listed below; all were corrected in the final-MM HTML in the same pass, except where marked.

## 3.Content Flags — Misstatements and Overclaims

**Flag 1 — "A *minhag* in Jerusalem" (Section III and fn 2).** The write-up has Rabbeinu Yonah noting that "it was a ג׳ in ילים׳ to recite it daily, and so it became a נה׳." Plaud: "he inspires a to achieve a גה־ in ו רבינו יונה ... ת שמים writes it's a לה for ת שמים to say פר שת היראה every day." The Sofer transcript has "Yerushalayim" for *yiras shamayim* several times ("the importance of Yerushalayim," "Yerushalayim is in your own hands"), and the summary turned that into a custom of Jerusalem. Corrected in the body and fn 2.

**Flag 2 — What the *Seder HaYom* says (Section IV, fn 4, fn 5).** The write-up: when a Jew says באמת שת התשובה, with ה, "it strengthens his resolve for ובה through the entire year." Plaud: "when a says פרשת

למעשה, שובה, he should be ון that all the עים in ישראל ' should do ובה" — which is exactly what the next paragraph then asks about ("how can he pray for them when he himself needs ובה?"). In the write-up that question had nothing to answer. Corrected; fn 4's "daily recital was instituted by משה בן מכיר ' and others" (not said) and fn 5's internal cross-reference ("file 50, fn 1; file 51") removed.

**Flag 3 — The meaning of ץ" ב (Section V, fn 10).** The write-up: למיד **שמשון בר צדוק** . Plaud: "the שי תיבות of ובות שמשון בר צדוק." The summary says " ז Shimshon bar Tzadok." Corrected in the body and fn 10.

**Flag 4 — The Maharam's students.** The write-up: "the of the ש" , רא of the כי, of the דה." Plaud: "the וות מיימוניות." (The summary and the Sofer transcript, "Agoyis," have the other.) Corrected.

**Flag 5 — The Baal Shem Tov's daughter and attendant (Section VII).** The write-up has the daughter **ל** and the attendant **רהם השמש** . Plaud: the lecturer spells the daughter's name aloud, "א ' ד ' ל, א" (English: Adele), and the attendant is "הירש משורת ' ." The Sofer transcript has "Abirush Meshulus" and the summary "Avraham the messenger" — both garbles of "Hirsh Mesharet." Corrected.

**Flag 6 — Who explains why Shlomo wrote it as he did.** The write-up: "The עזרא in his דמה explains." Plaud: "so the שיך הקדוש explains in the דמה" — the same Alshich who is the subject of the next section. The summary's "ע" " is the source of the error. Corrected.

**Flag 7 — Who wrote about being photographed (Section IX).** The write-up: "The ת יעריות שלמה in ת יונת אלם." Plaud: "The רב, יערות דבש תן אייבשיץ." Corrected. (A remark on photography attributed to a man who died in 1764 is an anachronism in the lecturer's own words, presumably about portraits; noted in fn 20.)

**Flag 8 — "The א in ת explains" (Section VIII, fn 15).** Plaud agrees with the write-up that the lecturer attributes the rats to the Gemara and names משרשיא. But on Sefaria (*Shabbos* 14a, Hebrew) the Gemara in the

name of משרשיא says only: “גזרו ביה רבנן, כיון דקחזו דקאתו לידי פסידא ואה” — they saw it was leading to loss. It does not mention mice; and the *tumah* in question is that of the scroll itself; the *tumah* of the hands has a separate reason on the same page: “ני שהידים עסקניות הן.” The write-up’s fn 15 gave a Hebrew “quotation” that matches neither and called it one of the Eighteen Decrees (not checked). Body and note corrected; the rats are now marked as the lecturer’s (traditional) telling.

**Flag 9 — The *Acharonim*.** The write-up: “זי ישראל struggled.” Plaud: “רונים take big issue with this.” Corrected.

**Flag 10 — Overclaims in the notes.** fn 13 said *Hodu* is “recited universally” in *Nusach Sefard* shuls (the lecturer: “almost”); fn 14 said the *Maor Einayim* records the whole story of the journey, the storm and the rescue (the lecturer: it records that the Besht instituted *Hodu*; the story he calls legend); fn 9 said the *Shulchan Aruch* itself gives the daily *Parshas HaMan* as a *segulah* for *parnassah* (on Sefaria, OC 1:5 only says it is good to say the passages of the *Akeidah*, the manna and the Ten Commandments; the *segulah* and the *Yerushalmi* are the lecturer’s report of the *Beis Yosef*). All hedged.

**Flag 11 — Smaller notes.** (a) The write-up has the Gra’s practice that “some make a ה: on לת when read from a י”; Plaud: the lecturer says that those shuls read from a *klaf*, is told that *Koheles* too is, and that the Vilna Gaon says to make a *berachah*. (b) “רני ראמים עד ביצי כינים” is placed by the lecturer in the prayer at *Shomea Tefillah*, not in *Pesukei DeZimra*. (c) The מועד cross-reference in fn 1, the Zohar folio in fn 22, *Bereishis Rabbah* 52:5 in fn 6, “(1735)” and the Jewish Historical Museum in fn 19, the siman in fn 19 and “buried in Tzfat” in fn 21 are additions that the recording does not support; hedged or removed (see Section 5). (d) The write-up’s fn 16 and body quote the *Mishnah* as י הקודש; the Mishnah has זובים (Sefaria, English “all the writings”). (e) **Not corrected:** the opening says Reb Yossi sat next to “Rabbi Avi” (the summary and Sofer transcript); Plaud has “Ari.” Left in the HTML, and listed as a question.

## 4.Content Flags — Omissions

Said in the shiur and left out of the write-up. None is substantive; the first four add color to the sources.

- **The lecturer's own caution about the *segulah*:** "I don't believe סגולות so easily… All I know is הייליגע יידן do it, so I guess it has a source." (Plaud.) The write-up has his "Who would refuse a סגולה?" but not this caution.
- **The coin:** the room reads that the other side bears a verse from *Tehillim*; the lecturer cites the Gemara's phrases for engraved and raised ("חק תוכות, חק ירכות"); and the inscription begins " ברוכים הבאים רבנו אליעזר בן…" with a wish that his coming to Amsterdam be לברכה והצלחה.
- **The four verses of the latecomer:** the lecturer says they are the acronym ("…יעקב (ישקני, שחורה, קומו, i.e. four named verses; the write-up says only "four פסוקים."
- **"The רשעים burn" and "an עונג שבת";** the verse לא תבערו אש בכל משבתיכם; and the exchange "Is Shabbos 25 hours? No, it is 24."
  - **Smaller asides:** that *Shir HaShirim* is a *segulah* for a *shidduch*; that the moments before Shabbos are holier than *Seudah Shlishis* as well as Shabbos; the gefilte-fish Rokeach joke; Muslim calligraphy; the 200 WhatsApps on the Tuesday of *Beshalach*; Pinny Katz (who "knows to say *Hodu*"); the mazel tov to Reb Shoali on Yoni's engagement; Lloyd Kilsen ("had an *einikel*"); the *Lechem Mishneh* remark from the room on Shabbos; a question on talking during the *Shema*, deferred.
- **The closing:** Plaud ends with "be מכוון to be מקיים the מצוה of עבדו את ה' בשמחה" and the acknowledgment of Rabbi Mendy Koenig (the hostages' families, bereaved soldiers, his *Shabbatonim*). The write-up ends on the funeral. Both restored in the Sefer Edition; the second is a community appeal the editors may prefer to cut.

## 5.Added or Editorial Material Not in the Shiur

Several footnotes carry background that the lecturer did not say. Most is plausible; some conflicted with what he said or could not be verified.

- **fn 1:** the gloss on *aravus* and *cheshbon hanefesh*. **fn 3:** “a foundational kabbalistic-halachic *siddur*… influenced post-davening *minhagim* in many Ashkenazic *kehillos*.” **fn 4:** the Ramban/Rambam comparison on command versus promise (not checked). **fn 5:** the cross-reference to “file 50.” **fn 7:** the Maharsha’s reasoning as “closeness with *Hashem*” (not what the lecturer said).
- **fn 13:** “universally.” **fn 14:** the account of the journey as the *Maor Einayim*’s. **fn 15:** the Hebrew “quotation” and the Eighteen Decrees. **fn 18:** the *Shaar HaKavanos*. **fn 19:** “(1735),” the museum, the siman. **fn 21:** “buried in Tzfat” and “1735–1740.” **fn 22:** the Zohar folio and *Tikkunei Zohar*. **fn 23:** “the Gemara develops Shlomo’s violation of all three.”
- Background that is accurate and can stay: the dates of the Rimanover (1745–1815), the Yaavetz (1697–1776) and the Maggid of Chernobyl (1730–1797); the distinction of the *Tashbetz Katan* from the later *Tashbetz* of R’ Shimon Duran; Ensisheim from 1286.

## 6.Halachic / Lomdish Observations

**Two decrees, not one (Shabbos 14a, checked on Sefaria).** The lecturer joins two things the Gemara keeps apart: the Sages decreed *tumah* on the *scroll* — that is what Rav Mesharshiya’s story is about — and they decreed *tumas yadayim* for a different reason, “because hands are busy.” The lecturer’s neat picture (stored together → rats → therefore hands become *tamei*) does not match either strand exactly. The Sefer Edition keeps his telling but adds the distinction in a bracketed note.

**The Maharsha and the Gemara itself (Berakhos 33b, checked).** The Gemara states the dictum in the name of R’ Chanina and itself brings Deut. 10:12 (“what does Hashem ask of you but to fear…”), and goes on to ask how fear of Heaven can be a small thing. So the question the lecturer raises is built into the sugya; his Maharsha (when one asks for *yirah* of Him, He cannot refuse) is reported, not retrieved.

**Shlomo’s three *lavin* (Sanhedrin 21b, checked).** The Gemara has Shlomo say “I will multiply and not turn away” (wives) and “I will multiply and not return” (horses). On silver and gold the page quotes the verses and Shlomo’s time but records no such statement of Shlomo’s. So 3 × 39 rests on the Rokeach counting all three *lavin*; the lecturer himself says “you can’t talk about Shlomo HaMelech like this.” Whether each *lav* of the king carries lashes is also assumed.

**Face, raised and sunken (Avodah Zarah 43b, checked).** The Gemara forbids the human face because man is made in God’s image, and treats a protruding figure on a signet as the concern (a sunken one may be worn). The Yaavetz’s two points as the lecturer gives them — face alone, and raised not sunken — are therefore consistent with the sugya. Which *Rishon* he cites for “face alone is only *drash*” is unclear in the recording (“the *shitah* of the Rosh”).

**The 117 hours.** The arithmetic (6 × 24 = 144; 3 × 1.5 × 6 = 27; 144 − 27 = 117) is correct; that *Shir HaShirim* has 117 verses is correct (the lecturer did not know, and neither did the room); 3 × 39 = 117 is also correct. The Zohar’s “hour and a half” is the lecturer’s hesitant recollection (“I believe”).

## 7.Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav

Q1.Where does the *Sefer HaYirah* say to recite *Parshas HaYirah* daily? (And is the book Rabbeinu Yonah’s?)

Q2.Which passage in the *Seder HaYom* says the one who recites *Parshas HaTeshuvah* should have in mind the *resha’im*?

Q3.Where is the *segulah* of *Parshas HaMan* in the *Beis Yosef* and the *Tur*, and what exactly does the lost *Yerushalmi* say?

Q4.Which passage of the *Maor Einayim* mentions *Hodu*, and where is the story of the journey told?

Q5.Is it Rashi on *Shabbos* 14a who has the rats?

Q6.Where does the Rokeach give the two calculations of 117, and in which edition?

Q7.Which *Rishon* holds that a face alone is only *drash*, and what are the Gemara's words for engraved and raised?

Q8.The Yaavetz's responsum: is it written from Altona ("my father's city") or Amsterdam, and where is it?

Q9.The four verses of the latecomer (*Yaakov*): which are they? And is it Rabbi Ari or Rabbi Avi beside whom Reb Yossi sat?

## 8.Bottom Line

*A faithful, well-ordered write-up of a warm, digressive shiur. As before, the errors came from the summary and the garbled Sofer transcript, and this week they clustered in who or what: the supposed Jerusalem custom (a mishearing of yiras shamayim), the Seder HaYom's actual teaching, the acronym of the Tashbetz, the Agudah for the Hagahos Maimoniyos, the Besht's attendant and daughter, the Ibn Ezra for the Alshich, and the Yaaros Devash. With those fixed, the Shabbos 14a story marked as the lecturer's, and the notes that outran the recording hedged, the Sefer Edition can stand. The weakest footnotes (3, 4, 5, 7, 13, 14, 15, 19, 21, 22, 23) stated more than the shiur or the sources support and were hedged.*

Produced by a content-based review pass reading the Plaud transcript (authoritative), the Sofer-style transcript, the AI summary and the finished write-up (as delivered, before the corrections described above were applied). No Sofer .docx was present for this date.